

6. Name the brave Indian King whom Alexander defeated on the bank of river Jhelum.

- (a) Ambhi (b) Porus
(c) Chandragupta Maurya (d) Mahapadma Nanda

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (b)

The realm of Puru (Porus) was located between Jhelum and Chenab river. Alexander defeated him on the bank of Jhelum river, but he was impressed by his courage and became his friend and returned his state and also gifted him some more areas.

7. Who one of the following had not come to India with Alexander?

- (a) Nearchus (b) Onesicritus
(c) Deimachus (d) Aristobulus

U.P.P.C.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Deimachus had not come to India with Alexander. According to Strabo, Seleucid emperor Antiochus sent his ambassador in the court of Bindusara named as Deimachus.

Maurya Empire

***Chandragupta Maurya** is considered as one of the greatest emperors of India. He was the first emperor who brought together the small fragmented kingdoms of the country and combined them into a single vast empire. He expanded his empire to the edge of what is now known as Iran. He was the one who first unified India politically. Kautilya had an exceptional contribution to the establishment of Mauryan dynasty. He was well known as 'Vishnugupta' and 'Chanakya.' When Chandragupta Maurya had the responsibility of united Indian empire as emperor, Kautilya served as prime minister, advisor and chief priest. He was the pioneer scholar of political science and also known for his famous book "**Arthashastra**". This is one of the oldest book which is based on the political condition of India. *In the **Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman** of 150 A.D., there is a description of the construction of Sudarshan lake for irrigation by '**Pushyagupta**', a provincial governor of Chandragupta Maurya, in the state of Anarta and Saurashtra (Gujarat). It proves that this part of western India was included in the Mauryan Empire. Chandragupta defeated the invading army of the ruler of the Eastern part of Alexander's empire **Seleucus**, in **305 BC**. ***Mudhrarakshasa** authored by **Vishakhadatta** provides the various information about the reign of Chandragupta Maurya. Dhundiraja had written a commentary on Mudhrarakshasa. In this drama, Chandragupta is described as the son of **Nandiraja**. This book depicts Chandragupta as "**Vrishal**" and "**Kulheen**". Besides Mudhrarakshasa, two other works of Vishakhadatta are - **Devichandragupatam** and **Abhisarika**

or **Abhisarika-bandhitkam** (unfounded).

***William Jones** was the first scholar who recognized **Sandrocottos** as Chandra Gupta Maurya. *Plutarch described him as **Androcottus**. **Justin**, a Greek writer, described the meeting of Sandrocottos and Alexander the Great.

*Greek writers have addressed Bindusara as '**Amitrochates**', as per the scholars - the Sanskrit form of Amitrochates is **Amitraghat** (killer of enemies). Jain texts call him '**Simhasena**'. In Jain texts, the name of the mother of Bindusara was '**Durdhara**'. According to Divyavadana, there was a revolt in Taxila (Takshashila) in the time of Bindusara, for which he sent his son Ashoka to suppress it. *According to Strabo, Antiochus I Soter sent **Deimachus** as an ambassador to Bindusara's court. *According to Pliny, King of Egypt, Ptolemy II Philadelphus sent **Dionysius** as an ambassador to Mauryan's court. Bindusara demanded three items from the ruler of Syria. These items were - sweet wines, dry figs and philosopher. Antiochus I Soter sent all the other things except philosophers to Bindusara.

According to Buddhist evidence, Ashoka was appointed as the viceroy of **Avanti** during his father's reign. *Except Assam and Deep South, entire India was under Ashoka's empire. *Ashoka's coronation on the throne of Magadha took place in **269 B.C.** *In his inscriptions everywhere he is called '**Devanampiya**', '**Devanampiyadasi**', which means 'Beloved of the Gods'. Ashoka announced the logical and practical '**Dhamma Niti**' to be followed by his pupils easily. *Ashoka's '**Dhamma**' is based on ethical principles which were not related to any community but declared for the welfare of humanity. *According to Sinhalese folklore - "**Dipavamsa**" and "**Mahavamsa**", the Third Buddhist Council was held in "Pataliputra" during the reign of Ashoka. The chairperson of this Buddhist Council was **Moggaliputta Tissa**, the famous Buddhist mendicant. *Ashokan inscriptions describe the history of Ashoka properly. The inscription can be divided into three classes;

- (1) Rock inscription/petrograph
- (2) Column inscription
- (3) Cave inscription

Rock inscription is a group of 14 various inscriptions which were found at different places - Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra, Kalsi, Girnar, Dhauli, Jaugada, Yerraguddi and Sopara. *Most of the inscriptions of Ashoka are written in the Prakrit language and **Brahmi script**, only two inscriptions, **Shahbazgarhi** and **Mansehra** are in the **Kharosthi** script. *One ruined inscription, written in Aramaic script is found from Taxila. **Shar-i-Kuna (Kandhar Inscription)** is in the bilingual (Greek and Aramaic) script.

*Ashoka built the first hospital and herbal garden in India. He established hospitals, public gardens, and gardens for the growing of medicinal herbs. He also organized digging of wells and planting of a tree for shades.

*Sri Lanka was not part of Ashoka's territory. The **second inscription** of Ashoka clarifies that **Chola, Pandayas, Sattiyaputta, Keralaputta** and **Tamraparni** (Sri Lanka) were not part of Mauryan reign. That's why they were called edge states. Some of the names of officials were found from the edicts of Ashoka, which are mentioned below –

YUKTA – These were the district officials who used to collect revenue.

RAJJUKA – Rajjuka was a category of officials in the rural area which worked as surveyors combined with judicial functions with assessment duties.

PRADESHIKA – It was a top official of the division. It can be compared with the current divisional commissioner. They used to perform judicial work also.

*The head of convoy of merchants was called as **Sarthwah** which is described in "Arthashastra" by Kautilya.

***Sarnath Pillar** was constructed by Ashoka. On top of this pillar, the shape of the lion is built which is the symbol of power. This replica is taken by the Indian government as its national emblem. These pillars are the best example of Mauryan architecture. * **James Prinsep** became the first scholar who deciphered Ashoka's inscription (Brahmi script). The edicts in Brahmi script mentioned a King Devanampiya Piyadassi which Prinsep initially assumed was a Sri Lankan King. Later, the fact was revealed that according to Singhali legends, Dipvamsa and Mahavamsa, the sobriquet was used for Ashoka. At last in 1915, **Maski inscription** (Karnataka) finalised the name of 'Ashoka.' ***Kharosthi script** was written from right to left in ancient India. It is mainly the script of north-west India.

*Ashoka visited Lumbini after the 20th year of his coronation. To mark the birthplace of Buddha, the pillar at **Rummindei** was erected along with some sacred stone structures. He exempted the Bali tax on Lumbini as it was the birthplace of Buddha and reduced the rate of land revenue from 1/6 to 1/8.

The name of Ashoka is mentioned in **Gujjara minor rock edict** located in Datia district, Madhya Pradesh. It was laid on the main road from Ujjain to Bharuch.

*Victory in Kalinga war was the greatest event of Ashoka's reign. The **13th rock edict** provides clear evidence of **Kalinga war**. It says King Piyadasi (Ashoka) conquered Kalinga, eight years after his coronation, i.e. in **261 BC**. He felt deep remorse for having conquered Kalinga. The reasons which prompted Ashoka to invade Kalinga were both political and economical. The territory of Kalinga was like a bridge between north and south. People of Kalinga dominated the Indian Ocean and controlled the overseas trade. Their supremacy on the eastern seacoast virtually closed the sea routes in the east for the Magadhan merchants. Similarly, the land routes for internal trade from the Gangetic valley toward Deccan were also controlled by Kalinga. If Kalinga remained independent, the overseas and land trades of Magadha would be affected. That is why it was necessary to invade Kalinga for Mauryan dynasty.

*In the first rock edict, Ashok inscribed as- "**here no living**

beings are to be slaughtered or offered in sacrifice". Formerly in the kitchen of King Piyadasi, hundreds of thousands of animals were killed every day to make curry. But now with the writing of this Dhamma edict, only three animals, two peacocks, and a deer are killed and even the deer not always. And in future, not even these three creatures will be killed."

*The second rock edict of Ashoka tells us about the South Indian Kingdom of **Chola, Pandya, Satiyaputta** and **Keralaputta** and **Tamraparni** (Sri Lanka). Apart from this, 13th rock inscription also mentions Chola, Pandya & Tamraparni. **13th inscription** of Ashoka provides information that he had a cordial relationship with five Greek kings namely- **Antiok** (Antiochus II Theos – the ruler of Syria), **Turmaya** or **Turamaya** (Ptolemy II Philadelphus – The ruler of Egypt), **Antakini** or **Anikini** (Antigonus Gonatas – The ruler of Macedonia), Mag, Makmaas or Megaras (**The ruler of Cyrene**), Alik Sundar or Aliero Sentro (**Alexander Epirus or the king of Epirus**). *The earliest known copper plate, known as **Sohgaura** (Gorakhpur, U.P.) is a Mauryan record that mentions earliest royal order to **preserve the food-grains to be utilized during the famine** in the country. *The other, the Mahasthan inscription of Bogura district of Bangladesh also describes the relief measures adopted during a famine in the region. The earliest epigraphic record of **land grants on the basis of religion** in India is found in the inscription of Satavahana. Mauryan emperors did not grant any land on religious basis.

*From the perspective of architecture, the **Stupa of Sanchi** is considered as best. Sanchi is located in the Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh. This stupa was built by Ashoka. *The **stupa of Bharhut** is situated in Satna district of Madhya Pradesh, which is dated approx 3rd century B.C. Bharhut stupa was discovered by Alexander Cunningham. *Amravati Stupa is located on the right bank of Krishna river in the Palnadu district of Andhra Pradesh. Colin Mackenzie traced this Stupa in 1797 A.D. ***Dhamekh Stupa** of Varanasi is related with Gupta period. **Bhabru inscription** proves Ashoka as Buddhist. In the same inscription, he referred to himself as '**Piyadasi Raja**' Magadha, i.e. the king of Magadha. After accepting the Buddhist religion, Ashoka stopped hunting and started pilgrimage trips. First, he visited Bodhgaya. **The sequence of his religious trip** is- Lumbini, Kapilavastu, Bodhgaya, Sarnath, Kushinagara, Shravasti.*The name of the five provinces of the Mauryan Empire is found on the Ashokan inscriptions –

Province	Capital
Uttarapatha	Taxila
Avantiratha	Ujjayini
Kalinga	Tosli
Dakshinapatha	Suvarnagiri
Prachyapatha	Pataliputra

***Megasthenese** was a Greek historian who came to India in the fourth century B.C. as a representative or ambassador

of **Seleucus Nicator**. He lived in the court of Chandragupta Maurya for five years. He has written about contemporary India and also about Chandragupta's reign in his book entitled "**Indica**." *Municipal administration of Pataliputra town is described in Megasthenes's 'Indica.' *According to this book, Pataliputra was governed by a **30-member** municipal council. It was divided into **six main committees** which had five members each. The 6th board was responsible for the collection of sales tax. This board made sure that every citizen must pay **one-tenth** of their earning as sales taxes to the government. The culprits were punished with a death sentence. He called the town officials as '**Astynomoi**'.

*Megasthenes divided Mauryan society into seven categories which are as follows :

(1) Philosophers (2) Farmers (3) Herdsmen (4) Artisans (5) Military (Soldier) (6) Overseers or Spies (7) Councillors and Assessors. Megasthenes does not mention slavery in India. According to him, no one could marry outside his caste, and no one could take to an occupation other than the one fixed for his caste.

*Mauryan emperors played a major role in the development of culture, art and literature. Chandragupta's empire spread over from Iran in the north-west to present-day north Karnataka in the south. "**Bhaga**" and "**Bali**" were the sources of revenue in ancient India. According to Arthashastra, King was the owner of the land. He had a share in produce from the land. This tax was known as 'Bhaga' whereas 'Bali' was also a source of revenue.

***Agronomoi** were known as district officers. **Shulkadhyaksha** used to collect various trade and service tax and **Akradhyaksha** controlled mines. The maintenance of crown land was done by **Sitadhyaksha** in Mauryan period. Revenue collected through this tax was known as '**Sita**'. *Revenue collection was regulated by **Samaharta** in Mauryan ministerial council. ***Antapal** looked after border forts while the **Pradeshtha** was an administrator of commissioners. *Mauryan officer **Pautavadhyaksha** was in charge of weights and measures while **Panyadhyaksha** was in charge of the Commerce Department, and **Sunadhyaksha** was the chief of the slaughterhouse. *"**Pankodakasannirodhe**" was the penalty in Mauryan administration for throwing dirt or causing mud and water to collect on the roads. *The Arthashastra mentions two types of courts:

***Dharmasthiya** which is analogous with modern civil courts and **Kantakshodhana** which is analogous to modern criminal courts.

*The town administration was governed by municipalities during the Mauryan period, whose chief was '**Nagrak**' or "**Purmukhya**". *Megasthenes mentioned six committees of five members municipal council of Pataliputra. Its third committee maintained the **record of registration of birth and death certificates**. This job is still carried out by municipal administration. *Arthashastra allows the **divorce**

of a wife deserted by her husband. Divorce was prevalent in the Mauryan period. Wife had the right to divorce on the basis of long abroad stay of her husband and being physically handicapped. Similarly, the husband had also the right to leave his wife for being barren or adulteress. *The system to govern villages through **autonomous elected panchayats** was evolved by Cholas. This custom was the base of village administration during that time. Village Assembly was independent to take any decision regarding any matter related to the village in the Mauryan period.

*It is mentioned clearly in Manusmriti that a widower, whose wife is dead, could remarry but a widow whose husband is dead, was not permitted for remarriage.

The foreign invaders who did not follow priestly customs or local traditions (Shakas, Kushans, Hunas, Pratihar) were stated as '**Fallen Kshatriyas**' in Manusmriti.

*Last Mauryan emperor was **Brihadratha**. Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander/lieutenant **Pushyamitra Shunga** in **184 B.C**. Pushyamitra Shunga established a new dynasty which is known as **Shunga Dynasty**. Pushyamitra Shunga was a **fanatic Brahmin**. He completed **two Ashwamedh Yajnas**. These two events were organised in the supervision of **Patanjali**, who wrote **Mahabhashya**.

*The last king of Shunga dynasty, **Devabhuti** was killed by a conspiracy of his '**Amatya**' **Vasudeva**. According to Vayupurana, the last ruler of the Kanva dynasty, **Susharma** was deposed by his Andhrian servant **Simuk**.

1. First Indian Empire was established by:-

- (a) Kanishka (b) Harsh
- (c) Chandra Gupta Maurya (d) Samundragupta

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Chandragupta Maurya is considered as one of the greatest emperors of India. He was the first emperor who brought together the small fragmented kingdoms of the country and combined them into a single large empire. He expanded his empire to the edge of what is now known as Iran. He was the one who first unified India politically.

2. The first Empire was established by which ruler in India?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Chandragupta II Vikramaditya
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (a)

See the explanation of above question.

3. Which among the following is India's oldest dynasty?

- (a) Gupta (b) Maurya
(c) Vardhana (d) Kushana

Uttarakhand Lower Sub. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Among the above options, Mauryan dynasty is India's oldest dynasty because it ruled from 321 B.C. to 184 B.C. It was established by Chandragupta Maurya. Afterwards, Kushan dynasty, Gupta dynasty (275 to 550 CE) and Vardhana dynasty ruled over ancient India.

4. Who was the founder of the Maurya Empire?

- (a) Bindusara (b) Brihadraha
(c) Ashoka (d) Chandragupta Maurya

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Chandragupta Maurya figures prominently in the book of –

- (a) Bhasa (b) Sudraka
(c) Vishakhadatta (d) Ashvaghosha

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

Mudrarakshasa authored by Vishakhadatta provides various information about the reign of Chandragupta Maurya. Dhundiraja had written a commentary on Mudrarakshasa. In this drama, Chandragupta is described as the son of Nandiraja. This book depicts Chandragupta as "Vrishal" and "Kulheena".

6. Who was called as 'Sandrocottos' by Justin, the Greek Writer?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Chandragupta I
(c) Chandragupta II (d) Samudragupta

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

William Jones was the first scholar who recognised Sandrocottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya. Arian and Plutarch also described him as Androcottus. Justin, a Greek writer, described the meeting of Sandrocottos and Alexander the Great.

7. Who recognized Sandrocottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya?

- (a) William Jones (b) V. Smith
(c) R. K. Mukherjee (d) D. R. Bhandarkar

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

8. Who of the following mentions about the meeting of Sandrocottos (Chandragupta Maurya) with Alexander, the Great

- (a) Pliny (b) Justin
(c) Strabo (d) Megasthenes

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Justin, a Greek writer, described the meeting of Sandrocottos and Alexander the Great.

9. Kautilya was prime minister of –

- (a) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(b) Ashoka
(c) Chandragupta Maurya
(d) King Janak

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Kautilya made an unforgettable contribution to the establishment of Mauryan dynasty. He was well known as 'Vishnugupta' and 'Chanakya.' When Chandragupta Maurya had the responsibility of uniting Indian empire as emperor, Kautilya served as prime minister, advisor and chief priest. He was the pioneer scholar of political science and also known for his famous book 'Arthashastra'. This is one of the oldest books which is based on the political condition of India.

10. By which name was Chanakya known in his childhood?

- (a) Ajaya (b) Chanakya
(c) Vishnugupta (d) Deogupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

Sage Chanak gave his son the name Chanakya. The ancient Arthashastra has been traditionally attributed to Chanakya by a number of scholars. Arthashastra identifies its author by the name of Kautilya, except for one verse that refers to him by the name of Vishnugupta. In the question, the name of Chanakya in childhood is asked, so, from the above-options Vishnugupta is found to be the most appropriate answer. According to researcher Trobman, Chanakya or Kautilya is presumably the name of the author's gotra (Clan).

11. Another name of Chanakya was :

- (a) Bhattswami (b) Vishnugupta
(c) Rajshekhar (d) Vishakhadatta

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

12. Kautilya's Arthashastra is a book on –:

- (a) economic relations
(b) principles and practice of statecraft
(c) foreign policy
(d) wealth accumulation
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

Ans (e)

Arthashastra by Kautilya is a treatise on polity during the Mauryan monarch/kingdom. The Saptang theory of the state was introduced in it, which includes the seven elements of the states, these are – The King (Swami), Minister (Amatya), Territory (Janpada), Fort (Durg), Treasury (Kosa), Army (Danda) and Allies (Mitra). Arthashastra gives its detailed description about the then administration and agrarian system.

13. The Arthashastra of Kautilya is a

- (a) Play about Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Biography
- (c) History of Chandragupta Maurya
- (d) Book on Principles of Government

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

14. Which one of the following is the seventh part of the State according to Saptang Theory of State?

- (a) Janapada
- (b) Durga
- (c) Mitra
- (d) Kosha

U.P.P.C.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

According to Saptang Theory of State, Mitra (Ally) is the seventh part of the state ; Ally is like the ear of the state. Allies of King assist him in peace and war. In this context, Kautilya differentiates between idealistic and fake allies. Natural is better than artificial. Any King, whose friend is greedy, prurient and coward, ruin is inevitable.

15. Kautilya's Arthashastra deals with the aspects of –

- (a) Economic life
- (b) Political policies
- (c) Religious life
- (d) Social life

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Arthashastra renders a wide range of information about Mauryan dynasty. This is the unique saga of political policies.

16. According to Kautilya's Arthashastra, which of the following are correct?

1. A person could be a slave as a result of a judicial punishment.
2. If a female slave bore her master a son, she was legally free.
3. If a son born to a female slave was fathered by her master, the son was entitled to the legal status of the master's son.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

As per Dasa-Kalpa chapter of Arthashastra, a person could be a slave as a result of a judicial punishment. Also if a female slave bore her master a son, she was legally set free, however this son will not have any legal status of the master's son. Hence, statements (1) and (2) are true, while statement (3) is false.

17. Which of the following can be compared to 'Prince' of Machiavelli ?

- (a) Kalidasa's 'Malvikagnimitram'
- (b) Kautilya's 'Arthashastra'
- (c) Vatsyayana's 'Kamasutra'
- (d) Thiruvalluvar's 'Thirukkural'

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Arthashastra is a unique book of political science which is compared with "The Prince" (il principe) of Machiavelli, the great Italian thinker.

18. Deimachus came to India during the reign of –

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Bindusara
- (c) Ashoka
- (d) Kanishka

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

According to Strabo, Syrian king Antiochus I - Soter sent his ambassador Deimachus to the court of Bindusara. He replaced Megasthenes.

19. Ashoka won the Avanti Mahajapad and merged in the Mauryan empire during Bindusara ruled. What text does it refer to?

- (a) Samant Pasadika of Buddha Ghosh
- (b) Arthashastra of Kautilya
- (c) Ashtadhyayi of Panini
- (d) Mahabhashya of Patanjali

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2020

Ans (a)

Ashoka won the Avanti Mahajanpad and merged it in the Mauryan empire during Bindusara rule. This is mentioned in the Samant Pasadika written by Buddha Ghosh.

20. Chandragupta's palace situated at Pataliputra is mainly made up of –

- (a) Bricks
- (b) Stones
- (c) Woods
- (d) Clays

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The archaeological remains of the Mauryan period have been discovered in Bulandibagh and Kumrahar near Patna (Ancient Pataliputra). It is known that the palace of Chandragupta Maurya was made of wood. The excavation was carried out by D.B. Spooner. The remains of the Pataliputra city wall from Bulandibagh and the remains of palace from Kumrahar have been found during the excavation.

21. The remains of which ancient city have been found at the Kumrahar site?

- (a) Vaishali (b) Pataliputra
(c) Kapilavastu (d) Shravasti

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

22. Bulandibagh was ancient site of :

- (a) Kapilavastu (b) Pataliputra
(c) Vaishali (d) Varanasi

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

23. Who amongst the following Mauryan rulers did conquer the Deccan?

- (a) Ashoka (b) Chandragupta
(c) Bindusara (d) Kunala

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The founder of the Mauryan dynasty, Chandragupta Maurya conquered the Deccan plateau. Jain and Tamil sources inscriptions found at various sites of southern India proved that Chandragupta Maurya expanded his empire into Deccan trap. Inscriptions of Ashoka were also found from many sites of the southern part of India, but he conquered the Kalinga only. In this situation, Chandragupta should be given the credit of Deccan Victory as Victory of Bindusara is doubtful and history never remembered him as a victor.

24. Who was the first king to conquer Malwa, Gujarat and Maharashtra?

- (a) Harsh (b) Skandgupta
(c) Vikramaditya (d) Chandragupta Maurya

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

The unification of India had taken proper shape in the leadership of Chandragupta Maurya. Early victories of Chandragupta Maurya stretched his boundaries from Beas to Indus river. Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman proved his sovereignty over Western India. The unified Mauryan empire extended from Bengal and Assam in the east to modern-day Afghanistan in the west, to Kashmir in the north and the Deccan plateau in the south.

25. Which of the following is not associated with Chandragupta Maurya?

- (a) Susima
(b) Sanchi
(c) Junagadh inscription of Rudradaman
(d) Vishnugupta

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (b)

Susima was eldest son of Bindusara and grandson of Chandragupta Maurya. Vishnugupta was another name of Kautilya, the mentor of Chandragupta Maurya. Junagadh rock inscription of Rudradaman mentions construction of Sudarshan lake by Chandragupta Maurya's governor Pushyagupta. Sanchi stupa was constructed by Ashoka and does not have any relation with Chandragupta Maurya.

26. The Inscription which proves Chandragupta's sway over western India is:

- (a) Kalinga Rock Inscription
(b) Girnar Rock Inscription of Ashoka
(c) Junagarh Rock Inscription of Rudradaman
(d) Sopara Rock Inscription of Ashoka

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The description of the construction of Sudarshan lake by Mauryan provincial governor "Pushyagupta" was found in the Junagadh rock inscription of Rudradaman which clearly proves that this western part of India was once the part of Mauryan empire.

27. That Gujarat was included in the Kingdom of Chandragupta Maurya is proved by

- (a) Greek accounts
(b) Junagarh Rock Inscription of Rudradaman
(c) Jain tradition
(d) Pillar Edict II of Ashoka

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

28. Which Indian king defeated Seleucus, the administrator of Sindh and Afghanistan appointed by Alexander -

- (a) Samudragupta (b) Ashok
(c) Bindusar (d) Chandragupta

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Chandragupta Maurya defeated the invading army of Seleucus in 305 BC. Seleucus was the governor of the eastern Macedonian empire.

29. In which year Chandragupta Maurya had defeated Seleucus?

- (a) 317 B.C. (b) 315 B.C.
(c) 305 B.C. (d) 300 B.C.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

30. Who constructed the Sudarshana Lake?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
(b) Samudragupta
(c) Chandragupta Vikramaditya
(d) Bimbisara

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

The Sudarshana Lake was constructed by the order of Emperor Chandragupta Maurya, the founder of the Maurya dynasty, through his governor Pushyagupta. This lake was situated in the middle of the Saurashtra region on the Girnar hills. Later, great emperors like Ashoka, Rudradaman and Skandgupta repaired and renovated this lake from time to time.

31. The given map relates to :



- (a) Kaniska at the time of his death.
(b) Samudragupta after the close of his South Indian campaign.
(c) Ashoka towards the close of his reign.
(d) Empire of Thaneswar on the eve of Harsha's accession.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

The given map is related to Ashoka. Ashoka's rock and pillar edicts give us the correct information about his empire. The whole India came under the kingdom of Ashoka, except Assam and some of the southern part of India.

32. Who established 'Rajdharma' on triplex bases of longanimity, liberty and compassion ?

- (a) Ashoka (b) Akbar
(c) Ranjit Singh (d) Shivaji

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (a)

Ashoka announced the logical and practical 'Dhamma Niti' to be followed by his pupils easily. Ashoka's 'Dhamma' is based on ethical principles which were not related to any community but declared for welfare of the humanity. Longanimity, liberty and compassion were triplex bases.

33. Consider the following statements regarding Ashoka:

1. The definition of Dhamma given by Ashoka has been taken from the "Rahulovada-Sutta".

2. In the 14th year of his reign, Ashoka appointed a new type of staff called Dhamma-Mahamatras.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) Both 1 and 2 (b) Neither 1 nor 2
(c) Only 1 (d) Only 2

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

As per Jha and Shrimali's Prachin Bharat Ka Itihas, the spirit of Ashoka's Dhamma has been taken from Buddhist text of Lakkhana Sutta of Digha Nikaya, Rahulovada-Sutta and Dhammapada. Therefore, the first statement is correct. Ashoka appointed Dhamma-Mahamatras in the 14th year of his reign to promote his social and moral code (Dhamma, which included ethical and religious conduct). Hence, the second statement is also correct.

34. Which one territory of the following was not a part of Ashoka's empire?

- (a) Afghanistan (b) Bihar
(c) Sri Lanka (d) Kalinga

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Sri Lanka was not part of Ashoka's territory. The second major rock edict of Ashoka clarifies that Chola, Pandyas, Satiyaputta, Keralaputta and Tamraparni (Sri Lanka) were not the part of Mauryan reign. That's why they were called edge states.

35. In which of the following inscriptions of Ashoka, mention has been made of South Indian kingdoms?

- (a) Third Major Rock Edict
- (b) Second Major Rock Edict
- (c) Ninth Major Rock Edict
- (d) First Pillar Inscription

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

There are 14 major rock edicts of Ashoka. Major Rock Edict II, describes the presence of Pandyas, Sattiyaputta, Keralaputta and Chola kingdom of South India.

36. India's first hospital and herbal gardens were built by?

- (a) Ashoka
- (b) Chandragupta Maurya
- (c) Lord Mahavir
- (d) Dhanvantari

U.P. Lower Sub. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

Ashoka built the first hospital and herbal garden in India. He founded hospitals, public gardens, and gardens for the growing of medicinal herbs. He also organized digging of wells and planting of a tree for shades and created a ministry for the care of the aborigines and subject races of India.

37. "In spite of being Buddhist, Ashoka did not leave belief in Hinduism" validation of this fact is:-

- (a) Pilgrims
- (b) Belief in Moksha
- (c) Epithet of "Devanampriya."
- (d) establishment of veterinary hospitals

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

The coronation of Ashoka was held in 269 B.C. He was named as 'Devanampriya (Devanampiya)' in his inscription which means beloved of Gods or handsome by looks. This indicates his belief in Hindu religion.

38. Which of the following sources mention the occurrence of the third Buddhist Council during the reign of Ashoka:

- 1. Inscriptions of Ashoka
- 2. Dipavamsa
- 3. Mahavamsa
- 4. Divyavadana

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2
- (b) 2, 3
- (c) 3, 4
- (d) 1, 4

Ans. (b)

According to Sinhalese folklore – "Dipavamsa" and "Mahavamsa", the third Buddhist Council was held in "Pataliputra" during the reign of Ashoka. The chairperson of this Buddhist Council was Moggaliputta Tissa, the famous Buddhist mendicant.

39. A Buddhist Council during the reign of Ashoka was held at –

- (a) Magadha
- (b) Pataliputra
- (c) Samastipur
- (d) Rajgriha

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

40. The following Mauryan rulers were the followers of Buddhism –

- 1. Chandragupta
- 2. Ashoka
- 3. Bindusara
- 4. Dasaratha

Select the correct answer –

- (a) 1 and 2
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 3 and 4
- (d) 2 and 4
- (e) 1 and 3

Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

Ashoka and his grandson Dasaratha were the followers of Buddhism. Dasaratha also adopted the title "Devanampiya" as his grandfather Ashoka.

41. Rajjuka's were:

- (a) Traders in the Chola Kingdom
- (b) Officers in the Mauryan administration
- (c) Feudal Lords in the Gupta empire
- (d) Soldiers in the Saka army

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

'Rajjuka' officials were mentioned in the edicts of Ashoka. Rajjukas were categories of officials in the rural areas, who worked as surveyors combined with judicial functions with assessment duties.

42. In the Mauryan administrative system, with which department is the term 'Pradeshtha' associated?

- (a) Revenue Department
- (b) Justice Department
- (c) Military Department
- (d) Economic Department

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

In the Mauryan administrative system, the 'Pradeshtha' were officials responsible for preventing crimes and were associated with the Judicial Department. Another officer named Pradeshtha is mentioned in Kautilya's Arthashastra, who was a divisional-level officer.

43. What was "Sarsthwah"?

- (a) Brokers
- (b) Convoy of Merchants
- (c) Moneylender
- (d) Pilgrims

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

The head of the convoy of merchants was called Sarsthwah which is described in "Arthashastra" by Kautilya.

44. Which one of the following officials was not a part of the Mauryan administration?

- (a) Agraharika
- (b) Yukta
- (c) Pradeshika
- (d) Rajjuka

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

Some of the names of officials were found from the edicts of Ashoka. His 3rd edict mentioned three (3) officers which are mentioned below –

YUKTA – These were the district officials there to collect revenue.

RAJJUKA – Rajjuka was a category of officials in the rural area who worked as surveyors combined with judicial functions.

PRADESHIKA – He was a top official of the division. He can be compared with the modern day commissioner. They used to perform judicial work also.

45. Sarnath Pillar was built by –

- (a) Harshavardhana
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Gautam Buddha
- (d) Kanishka

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Sarnath Pillar was constructed by Ashoka. On top of this pillar, the shape of the four lions is built which is the symbol of power. This replica is taken by the Indian government as its national sign. These pillars are the best example of Mauryan architecture. All columns of the Mauryan era are constructed from sandstones of Chunar.

46. Which one of the following is considered the best Stupa ?

- (a) Amravati
- (b) Bharhut
- (c) Sanchi
- (d) Sarnath

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (c)

From the perspective of architecture, the Stupa of Sanchi is considered the best. Sanchi is located in the Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh. This stupa was built by Ashoka. It is famous across the world for its stupas, monasteries, temples and pillars, which date back to the 3rd century B.C. Thus option (c) is the right answer. The stupa of Bharhut is situated in Satna district of Madhya Pradesh. Bharhut stupa was discovered by Alexander Cunningham. Amravati Stupa is located on the right bank of Krishna river in the Palnadu district of Andhra Pradesh. Colin Mackenzie traced this Stupa in 1797 A.D. Dhamekh Stupa of Sarnath (Varanasi) was built during the time of Ashoka, whose present form was built during the Gupta period. This stupa is designed on a flat surface without raising the base.

47. Who of the following ruler constructed the 'Sanchi Stupa'?

- (a) Bimbisara
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Harshavardhana
- (d) Puyamitra

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

48. Who constructed the 'Sanchi Stupa'?

- (a) Chandragupta
- (b) Kautilya
- (c) Gautam Buddha
- (d) Ashoka

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

49. It was also ancient name of world famous tourist destination of Sanchi

- (a) Kaknam
- (b) Ventravati
- (c) Besnagari
- (d) Dashpura

[M.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2020]

Ans. (a)

Sanchi is situated in Raisen district of Madhya Pradesh. A number of stupas are erected here over top of a mountain. There are total 3 stupas here. Stupa number 1 is primary stupa. Stupa 2 has remains of Dhamma Mahamatyas of Ashoka while the remains of Sariputra and Mudgalayan have been found in Stupa 3. These stupas were constructed by Ashoka. 4th CE Gupta inscription calls it Kakanam Mahavihara.

50. The Stupa of Bharhut is a fine example of –

- (a) Chola architecture
 - (b) Kushan architecture
 - (c) Gupta architecture
 - (d) Shunga architecture
- (e) Question not attempted

Ans. (d)

The Stupa of Bharhut is situated near Satna in the state of Madhya Pradesh. It was probably built around 150 B.C. during Sunga period. Stupa of Bharhut is a fine example of Shunga Architecture. This site represents the people's movement in sculptural art and architecture science of ancient India.

51. Which among the following Stupa gateway depicts the pilgrimage to the Bodhi tree by Ashoka with his two queens?

- (a) Bharhut (b) Sanchi
(c) Sonari (d) Satdhara

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

The depiction of Ashoka's pilgrimage to the Bodhi Tree with his two queens is associated with the Great Stupa at Sanchi, located in the state of Madhya Pradesh, which is one of the oldest and most well preserved Buddhist Stupa. The Toranas are rich in symbolism and serve as visual narratives of important Buddhist events.

52. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the codes given below :

List-I (Place)	List-II (Monuments/Ruins)
A. Kaushambi	1. Dhamek Stupa
B. Kushinagar	2. Ghositarama Monastery
C. Sarnath	3. Ranabhar Stupa
D. Shravasti	4. Sahet-Mahet

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	3	4
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	2	3	1	4
(d)	4	2	1	3

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched list is as follows :

List-I (Place)	List-II (Monuments/Ruins)
Kaushambi	- Ghositarama Monastery
Kushinagar	- Ranabhar Stupa
Sarnath	- Dhamek Stupa
Shravasti	- Sahet-Mahet

53. In the course of pilgrimage, Emperor Ashoka visited the following places. Which route did he follow ?

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

1. Gaya 2. Kapilavastu
3. Kushinagar 4. Lumbini
5. Sarnath 6. Shravasti

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6
(b) 1, 3, 4, 2, 5 and 6
(c) 4, 5, 6, 3, 2 and 1
(d) 4, 2, 1, 5, 3 and 6

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

After accepting the Buddhist religion, Ashoka stopped hunting and started pilgrimage trips. He went to Bodhgaya after 10 years of his coronation and Lumbini after 20 years. Historian Vincent Arthur Smith has placed dhamma voyage (dhamma yatra) of Ashoka with Uggupta in his book 'Ashoka : the Buddhist Emperor of India' based on historical facts in the following order - Lumbini, Kapilavastu, Bodhgaya, Sarnath, Kushinagar, Shravasti.

54. Language used in the inscriptions of Ashoka is ?

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit
(c) Pali (d) Hindi

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Ashokan inscriptions describe the history of Ashoka properly. The inscription can be divided into three classes;
(1) Rock inscription/petrograph
(2) Column inscription
(3) Cave inscription.
Rock inscription is a group of 14 inscriptions which were found at different places – Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra, Kalsi, Girnar, Dhauli, Jaugada, Yerragudi and Sopara. Most of the inscriptions of Ashoka are written in the Prakrit language and Brahmi script, and only two inscriptions, Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra are in Kharosthi script. One ruined inscription, written in Aramaic script, was found from Taxila. Shar-i-Kuna (Kandhar Inscription) is in the bilingual (Greek-Aramaic) script while one Aramaic script of Ashokan inscription was obtained from Laghman.

55. The script written on Ashoka's Pillars is

- (a) Brahmi (b) Samaritan
(c) Pali (d) Sanskrit

70th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

56. Which one of the following Ashokan inscription is in "Kharosthi" script?

- (a) Khalsi (b) Girnar
(c) Shahbazgarhi (d) Meerut

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

57. The earliest inscription on stone was in which language?

- (a) Pali (b) Sanskrit
(c) Prakrit (d) Brahmi

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

58. The Brahmi script was first deciphered by letters inscribed on –

- (a) Stone tablets (b) Seal
(c) Pillars (d) Coins

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

The Brahmi script was first deciphered through the letters inscribed on stone tablets. Sir James Prinsep was the first philologist who accomplished the task of deciphering the script of Ashokan inscription so, option (a) is the correct answer.

59. The first scholar who read Ashokan edicts was –

- (a) Buhler (b) Robert Sebel
(c) James Prinsep (d) Cordriguttan

U.P.P.C.S. (GIC) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

60. Ashokan inscriptions were first deciphered by

- (a) James Prinsep (b) George Buhler
(c) Vincent Smith (d) Ahmad Hasan Dani

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

61. Who first deciphered the Brahmi script ?

- (a) A. Cunningham (b) A.H. Dani
(c) Buhler (d) James Prinsep

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

62. Who was the First Britisher to study Ashoka's edicts?

- (a) John Tower (b) Harry Smith
(c) Charles Metcalfe (d) James Prinsep

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

63. Who of the following had first decipher the edicts of Emperor Ashoka?

- (a) George Buhler (b) James Prinsep
(c) Max Muller (d) William Jones

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

64. Ashokan inscriptions in north-western part of the Mauryan Empire near Peshawar were in:

- (a) Brahmi Script
(b) Aramaic Script
(c) Devanagari Script
(d) Kharosthi Script

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre.) 2021

Ans. (d)

Most of the inscription of Ashoka are written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script, only two inscription, Shahbazgarhi and Manshera's (Kyber Pakhtunkhwa province, Pakistan) are in Kharosthi script.

65. Pre-Ashokan Brahmi script was found at :

- (a) Nagarjunakonda (b) Anuradhapura
(c) Brahmagiri (d) Maski

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Pre-Ashokan Brahmi script was found at Anuradhapura, Sri Lanka. Piparaha, Sohgaure, Mahasthan are the sites from where evidence of such script has been found.

66. Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?

- (a) Brahmi (b) Nandnagari
(c) Sharada (d) Kharoshti

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Kharosthi script was written from right to left in ancient India. It is mainly the script of north-west India. The study of Kharosthi palaeography began with the decipherment of the script which was accomplished through the efforts of James Prinsep (1835 A.D.), Friedrich Grotefend (1836 A.D.), Lassen (1838 A.D.) etc.

67. Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?

- (a) Brahmi (b) Sharada
(c) Kharosthi (d) Nandanagari
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

The Kharosthi Script is an ancient script used by the ancient Gandhara culture of South Asia primarily in modern-day Afghanistan & Pakistan. Kharosthi was A cursive script written from right to left.

68. The name by which Ashoka is referred to in his inscriptions is :

- (a) Chakravarti (b) Dharmadeva
(c) Dharmakirti (d) Priyadarshi

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The name by which Ashoka is referred in his inscription is "Priyadarshi" (Piyadasi), "Devanampiya Piyadasi" which means "Beloved of the Gods". He has also been stated as "Ashok Vardhan" in Puranas.

69. The name by which Ashoka is generally referred to in his inscriptions is

- (a) Chakravarti
(b) Priyadarshi
(c) Dharmadeva
(d) Dharmakirti
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

[65th B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2019]

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

70. Which of the kings has been mentioned as 'Piyadassi' and 'Devanampriya' in inscriptions?

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Ashoka
(c) Samudragupta (d) Harshavardhana

M.P.P. C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

71. Which one of the following statements regarding Ashokan stone pillars is incorrect?

- (a) These are highly polished
(b) These are monolithic
(c) The shaft of pillars is tapering in shape
(d) These are parts of architectural structures

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Ashokan stone pillars are not part of architectural structures, but these are distinct sculptures. Rest three statements are correct in the reference of Ashokan stone pillars.

72. In which of the following relief sculpture inscriptions is 'Ranyo Ashoka' (King Ashoka) mentioned along with the stone portrait of Ashoka?

- (a) Kanganahalli (b) Sanchi

(c) Shahbazgarhi

(d) Sohgaure

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Kanganahalli Buddha stupa is located on the bank of Bhima river in Kalaburagi district of Karnataka. There is a stone portrait of Ashoka along with his Queen below which 'Ranyo Ashoka' (King Ashoka) has been written.

73. Which one of the following edicts mentions the personal name of Ashoka ?

- (a) Kalsi (b) Rummindei
(c) Special Kalinga Edict (d) Maski

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Ashokan history is mainly known by his inscriptions. More than 40 edicts of Ashok are acquired/procured. The personal name of Ashoka is mentioned in Gujjarra, Maski, Nettur and Udagolam edicts.

74. In which of the following inscriptions the name of 'Ashoka' has been mentioned?

- (a) Bhabru Edict
(b) Rock Edict XIII
(c) Rummindei Pillar Inscription
(d) Minor Rock Edict of Maski

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2007

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

75. Which one of the following inscriptions contains the name of Ashoka?

- (a) Gujjarra (b) Ahraura
(c) Brahmagiri (d) Sarnath

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

76. The Rummindei Pillar of Ashoka was put up to mark –

- (a) Birth of Buddha
(b) Enlightenment of Buddha
(c) First Sermon of Buddha
(d) Demise of Buddha

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (a)

Ashoka visited Lumbini after the 20th year of his coronation. To mark the birthplace of Buddha, the pillar at Rummindei was erected along with some sacred stone structure. He condoned the Bali tax of Lumbini as it was the birthplace of Buddha and reduced the rate of land revenue from 1/6 to 1/8.

77. The Gujarra minor rock edict, in which the name of Ashoka is mentioned, is located in

- (a) Mirzapur district of Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Datia district of Madhya Pradesh
- (c) Jaipur district of Rajasthan
- (d) Champaran district of Bihar

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The name of Ashoka is mentioned in Gujarra minor rock edict, located in Datia district, Madhya Pradesh. It was laid on the main road from Ujjain to Bharuch.

78. The only pillar on which Ashoka declares himself as the emperor of Magadha –

- (a) Minor pillar of Maski
- (b) Rummindei pillar
- (c) Queen pillar
- (d) Bhabru pillar

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (d)

Bhabru (Bairat) inscription proves Ashoka as Buddhist. In the same inscription, he referred to himself as 'Piyadasi Raja' Magadha, i.e. the king of Magadha.

79. Kalsi is famous for –

- (a) Buddhist Chaityas
- (b) Persian Coins
- (c) Rock edicts of Ashoka
- (d) Temples of Gupta period

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Kalsi is located in Dehradun district of Uttarakhand. It is famous for Ashokan rock edict.

80. Where in Uttarakhand, was a copy of Emperor Ashok's Rock Edicts discovered ?

- (a) Nainital
- (b) Pauri
- (c) Tehri
- (d) Kalsi

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

81. Consider the following pairs :

Site of Ashoka's major rock edicts	Location (State)
------------------------------------	------------------

- | | |
|-------------|------------------|
| 1. Dhauli | – Odisha |
| 2. Erragudi | – Andhra Pradesh |
| 3. Jaugada | – Madhya Pradesh |
| 4. Kalsi | – Karnataka |

How many pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one pairs
- (b) Only two pairs
- (c) Only three pairs
- (d) All four pairs

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Dhaulti is in Odisha, Erragudi is in Andhra Pradesh, Jaugada is in Odisha and Kalsi is in Uttarakhand. (As per given options for Ashoka's major rock edicts)

82. Which of the following Rock Edict of Ashoka speaks of religious synthesis ?

- (a) Rock Edict – XII
- (b) Rock Edict – II
- (c) Rock Edict – XI
- (d) Rock Edict – XIII

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

Major Rock Edict II: This rock edict, describes South Indian Kingdom Chodas (Cholas), Pandyas, Satiyaputta, Keralaputta as well as the Tamraparni and Yavana king named Antiyoka and also the kings who were the neighbours of the Antiyoka. It has also mention of providing medical treatment for human and animals. **Major Rock Edict XI:** It explains the policy of dhamma and also emphasises on the individuals attitude towards elders and also abstaining from killing animals and being generous towards friends. **Rock Edict XII:** It directed and made request for tolerance among different religious sects. **Major Rock Edict XIII:** This rock edict says the way of conquest is dhamma not war. This was logical culmination of the thorough processes which began from the 1st rock edict.

83. Which Ashokan Rock Edict describes the victory and injuries of Kalinga war?

- (a) Rock edict I
- (b) Rock edict II
- (c) Rock edict XII
- (d) Rock edict XIII

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (d)

The Kalinga war and the victory over Kalinga were the greatest events of Ashoka's reign. The 13th rock edict provides clear evidence of the Kalinga war. It describes King Piyadasi (Ashoka) conquered Kalinga, eight years after his coronation, i.e. in 261 B.C., he described deep remorse for having conquered Kalinga in this edict.

84. In which inscription, Kalinga victory is mentioned?

- (a) Maski Inscription
- (b) Rudradaman Inscription
- (c) Junagarh Inscription
- (d) Hathigumpha Inscription
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans (e)

Kalinga Victory is mentioned in Ashoka's Rock Edict Number 13. Hence option (e) is correct.

85. The accounts of Kalinga War is known to us by the

- (a) Rock Edict-XIII
- (b) Rummindei Pillar Inscription
- (c) Accounts of Hiuen Tsang
- (d) Minor Rock Edict-I

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

86. Which of the following Ashokan inscriptions is devoted to the principle of religious tolerance completely?

- (a) Rock edict XIII
- (b) Rock edict XII
- (c) Pillar inscription VII
- (d) Bhabru minor rock edict

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

In the 12th major rock edict of Ashoka, there is the declaration of religious longanimity and growth of the essence of all communities.

87. Who among the following rulers advised his subjects through this inscription?

"Whosoever praises his religious sect or blames other sects out of excessive devotion to his own sect, with the view of glorifying his own sect, he rather injures his own sect very severely."

- (a) Ashoka
- (b) Samudragupta
- (c) Harshavardhana
- (d) Krishnadeva Raya

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (a)

Mentioned statement is found on Ashoka's 12th major Rock Edict by which Ashoka has preached about religious harmony.

88. The Ashokan major rock edicts which tell us about the Sangam Kingdom include rock edicts :

- (a) I and X
- (b) I and XI
- (c) II and XIII
- (d) II and XIV

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

The rock edict second and thirteen of Ashoka tells us about the Sangam Kingdom of Chola, Pandya, Satiyaputta and Keralaputta along with Tamraparni (Sri Lanka).

89. Which of the following South Kingdoms is not mentioned in the Ashokan inscriptions?

- (a) Chola
- (b) Pandya
- (c) Satiyaputta
- (d) Satavahana

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

90. Ptolemy Philadelphus who had diplomatic relation with Ashoka, was king of:

- (a) Cyron
- (b) Egypt
- (c) Macedonia
- (d) Syria

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

13th inscription of Ashoka provides information that he had a cordial relation with five Yavana kings namely- Antioch (Antiochus II Theos – the ruler of Syria), Turmaya or Turamaya (Ptolemy II Philadelphus – The ruler of Egypt), Antakini or Anikini (Antigonos Gonatas – The ruler of Macedonia), Mag (The ruler of Cyrene), Alik Sundar or Aliero Sentro (Alexander Epirus or the king of Epirus).

91. Turamaya, a contemporary of Ashoka was the ruler of –

- (a) Egypt
- (b) Corinth
- (c) Macedonia
- (d) Syria

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

92. Rulers of which of the following dynasties had diplomatic relations with distant countries like Syria and Egypt?

- (a) Chola
- (b) Gupta
- (c) Maurya
- (d) Pallavas

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

93. The central point in Ashoka's Dhamma is :-

- (a) loyalty to the king
- (b) peace and non-violence
- (c) respect to elders
- (d) religious toleration
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (e)

Ashoka's Dhamma was primarily based on a policy of peace, non-violence & religious toleration. In his 12th rock edict, religious longanimity and growth of the essence of all communities is mentioned. Hence as per the options, option (e) is correct.

94. Which of the following inscriptions of Ashoka bans animal sacrifice on certain festive gatherings, that probably included a ban on animal killing as well?

- (a) Rock Edict I
- (b) Pillar Edict V
- (c) Rock Edict IX
- (d) Rock Edict XI

Ans. (b)

In the first rock edict, Ashok inscribed as "here no living beings are to be slaughtered or offered in sacrifice. Formerly in the kitchen of King Piyadasi, thousands of animals were killed everyday for meat. But now with the writing of this Dhamma edict, only three creatures, two peacocks, and a deer are killed out of which deer is not always killed and in future, not even these three creatures will be killed." But as per the question, option (b) is the most suitable answer. According to 5th Pillar edict : King Ashok speaks - After anointing twenty-six years the following animals were declared by me inviolable, viz. parrots, mainas, the arumna, ruddy geese..... Fish are inviolable and must not be sold on the three chaturmasis and on the tishya full moon for three days and on every fast day.

95. Which one of the following ancient Indian records is the earliest royal order to preserve food-grains to be utilised during the crisis in the country?

- (a) Sohgaure Copper-plate
- (b) Rummindei Pillar -edict of Asoka
- (c) Prayaga-Prasasti
- (d) Mehrauli Pillar inscription of Chandra

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (a)

The earliest known copper plate, known as Sohgaure (Gorakhpur, U.P.) is a Mauryan record that mentions earliest royal order to preserve the food-grains to be utilized during the famine in the country. The other, the Mahasthan inscription of Bogura district (Bangladesh) also describes the relief measures adopted during a famine in the region.

96. Assertion (A) : Ashoka annexed Kalinga to the Mauryan Empire.

Reason (R) : Kalinga controlled the land and sea routes to South India.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (a)

The reasons which prompted Ashoka to invade Kalinga were both political and economical. The territory of Kalinga was like a bridge between north and south. People of Kalinga dominated the Indian Ocean and controlled the overseas

trade. Their supremacy on the eastern sea coast virtually closed the sea routes in the east for the Magadhan merchants. Similarly, the land routes for internal trade from the Gangetic valley toward Deccan were also controlled by Kalinga. If the Kalinga were independent, the overseas and land trades of Magadha would be affected. That is why it was necessary to invade Kalinga for Mauryan dynasty. So, both the Assertion (A) and the Reason (R) are correct, and the Reason (R) is the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).

97. Assertion (A) : The Mauryan kings did not bestow land-grants on religious basis.

Reason (R) : The peasants revolted against land grants.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

The earliest epigraphic record of land grants on the basis of religion in India is found in the inscription of Satavahana. Mauryan emperors did not grant any land on religious basis. There is no description found about peasant revolt against land grants. Thus, Assertion (A) is right, while Reason (R) is wrong.

98. Famous Greek ambassador Megasthenes came to the court of which emperor?

- (a) Ashoka
- (b) Harsha Vardhana
- (c) Chandragupta Maurya
- (d) None of the above

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Megasthenes was a Greek historian who came to India in the fourth century B.C. as a representative or ambassador of Seleucus Nicator. He lived in the court of Chandragupta Maurya. He has written about contemporary India and also about Chandragupta's reign in his book entitled "Indica."

99. Megasthenes was the ambassador of -:

- (a) Seleucus
- (b) Alexander
- (c) Darius
- (d) the Greeks
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (a)

See the explanation of above question.

100. During whose rule did Megasthenes come to India?

- (a) Ashoka
- (b) Harshvardhan
- (c) Chandragupta Maurya
- (d) Kumargupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

101. In how many categories did Megasthenes divide the Indian Society?

- (a) Four
- (b) Five
- (c) Six
- (d) Seven

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Megasthenes divided Mauryan society into seven categories which are as follows :

(1) Philosophers (2) Farmers (3) Herdsmen (4) Artisans (5) Military (Soldier) (6) Overseers or Spies (7) Councillors and Assessors. Megasthenes does not mention slavery in India. According to him, no one could marry outside his caste, and no one could take to an occupation other than the one fixed for his caste according to the varna system.

102. The division of Mauryan society into seven classes is particularly mentioned in -:

- (a) Kautilya's Arthashastra
- (b) Ashokan edicts
- (c) the Puranas
- (d) the Indica of Megasthenes
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017

Ans (d)

See the explanation of above question.

103. Which of the following sources states that there was no slavery in ancient India?

- (a) Arthashastra
- (b) Mudrarakshasha
- (c) Megasthenes' Indica
- (d) Vayupuran

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

104. The division of Mauryan 'Society into seven classes' is particularly mentioned in

- (a) Kautilya's Arthashastra
- (b) Ashokan Edicts
- (c) The Puranas
- (d) Megasthenes' Indica

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

105. Who stated that there were two types of philosophers: Brahmins and Shramanas?

- (a) Kautilya
- (b) Megasthenes
- (c) Upagupta
- (d) None of these

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

The book "Indica" written by Megasthenes in Greek describes that Indian society was divided into seven main classes (philosophers, farmers, herdsman, overseers, councillors, soldiers, and artisans). According to Megasthenes' account, Indian philosophers were divided into two groups: Brahmins and Shramanas.

Brahmins: Those who believed that liberation (moksha) could be achieved through knowledge of the Brahman (supreme reality). Shramanas: Those who believed that liberation could be attained through ascetic practices (shrama).

106. In the Mauryan period, tax evasion was punished with –

- (a) Death
- (b) Confiscation of goods
- (c) Imprisonment
- (d) None of the above

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

The municipal administration of Pataliputra town is described in 'Megasthenes' 'Indica.' According to this book, Pataliputra was governed by a 30-member municipal council. It was divided into six main committees which had five members each. The 6th board was responsible for the collection of sales tax. The culprits of tax evasion were punished with a death sentence. So, option (a) is the correct answer.

107. The description of the administration of Pataliputra is available in

- (a) Divyanadan
- (b) Arthashastra
- (c) Indica
- (d) Ashoka's inscriptions

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (c)

The description of the administration of Pataliputra is found in Megasthenes' 'Indica'. Megasthenes mentioned six committees of five members each to look after the administration of Pataliputra. He referred to the town officials as 'Astynomi.'

108. Which of the following sources gives a detailed account of city administration of the Mauryas ?

- (a) Kautilya's Arthashastra

- (b) Megasthenes' Indica
- (c) Mudrarakashasa of Vishakh Datta
- (d) Inscription of Ashoka

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

109. What is the name of Megasthenes' book?

- (a) Economics
- (b) Rig Veda
- (c) Purana
- (d) Indica

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

110. 'Indica' was originally written by –

- (a) Nearchus
- (b) Megasthenes
- (c) Plutarch
- (d) Diodorus

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

111. Who was the author of 'Indica'?

- (a) Vishnugupta
- (b) Megasthenes
- (c) Deimachus
- (d) Pliny

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

112. Who was the author of 'Indica'?

- (a) Plutarch
- (b) Justin
- (c) Herodotus
- (d) Megasthenes

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

113. Which function of the present municipal administration has been continuous from the time of Mauryan period?

- (a) Inspection of weights and measures
- (b) Fixing of the prices of goods
- (c) Registration of births and deaths
- (d) Patronage to artisans

[R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre)-1992]

Ans. (c)

In the Mauryan era, the administration of cities was carried out by municipalities headed by a 'Nagrak' or 'Purmukhya'. Megasthenes has mentioned 6 committees of the city council with 5 members each. Among these, the third committee was tasked with keeping accounts of birth-death registration. At present also, this work is done by municipal administration.

114. Which one of the following administrative structures in ascending order is correct?

- (a) Dronamukha, Sthaniya, Samgrahana, Karvatika
- (b) Sthaniya, Karvatika, Dronamukha, Samgarhana
- (c) Sthaniya, Dronamukha, Karvatika, Samgarhana
- (d) Sthaniya, Dronamukha, Samgarhana, Karvatika

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (*)

Kautilya prescribes a different scheme of Mauryan rural level administrative tier. At the top of the tier was the unit called 'Sthaniya' consisting of 800 villages. Then came 'Dronamukh' of 400 villages; further below stood 'Karvatika' of 200 villages and the lowest level the 'Samgrahan' consisting of 10 villages. Hence the given question is incorrect. Its ascending order is as follows- Samgrahana, Karvatika, Dronamukh, Sthaniya.

115. Which of the following statements are correct about Mauryan Kings? They developed –

- A. Culture, Art and Literature
- B. Gold coins
- C. Provincial Division
- D. Kingship to Hindukush

Code :

- (a) Only A
- (b) Only B
- (c) A, B and C
- (d) A, C, and D

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (d)

Mauryan emperors played a major role in the development of culture, art and literature. Chandragupta's empire spread over from Iran in the north-west to present north Karnataka in the south. According to historian Smith, Hindukush mountains were the strategic frontier of India. There were five provinces described in inscriptions of Ashoka i.e.

(1) Uttarapath (2) Avantiratha (3) Kalinga (4) Dakshinapath (5) Prachyapatha.

Regularization of gold coins in India is credited to Indo-Greek kings. Hence A, C, D are correct about Mauryan emperors.

116. 'Bhaga' and 'Bali' were:

- (a) Military Departments
- (b) Sources of Revenue
- (c) Religious Ceremonies
- (d) Administrative Divisions

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (b)

"Bhaga" and "Bali" were the sources of revenue in ancient India. According to Arthashastra, King was the owner of the land. He had a share in produce from the land. This tax was known as 'Bhaga' whereas 'Bali' was also a source of revenue.

117. Land revenue, which was the chief source of income during the Mauryan period, was collected by which officer?

- (a) Agronomoi (b) Shulkadhyaksha
(c) Sitadhyaksha (d) Akradhayaksha

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Sitadhyaksha was the head of agricultural land in the Mauryan empire, and he also dealt with land revenue levitation while Agronomoi were known as district officers. Shulkadhyaksha used to collect various trade and service taxes and Akradhyaksha controlled mines. So, option (c) is the correct answer.

118. 'Sita' in Mauryan period means:

- (a) A goddess
(b) A religious sect
(c) Revenue from Crown land
(d) Barren land.

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

The maintenance of crown land was done by Sitadhyaksha in the Mauryan period. Revenue collected through this tax was known as 'Sita'.

119. In ancient India, which tax was levied on pastures?

- (a) Akshayanivi (b) Bhaga
(c) Bhagna-Pravistaka (d) Vivit

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

In Mauryan times, the officer in charge of the pasture land was called "Vivitadhyaksha."
In ancient India (Mauryan period), the tax imposed on pastures was known as "Vivit" (Vivita).

120. Who of the following was associated with the collection of revenue in Mauryan Mantriparishad ?

- (a) Samaharta (b) Vyabharika
(c) Antapala (d) Pradeshtha

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (a)

Revenue collection was regulated by Samaharta in Mauryan ministerial council. Antapal looked after border forts while the Pradeshtha was administrator of commissioneraries.

121. Which of the following Mauryan officers was in charge of weights and measures?

- (a) Pautavadhyaksha (b) Panyadhyaksha
(c) Sitadhyaksha (d) Sunadhyaksha

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (a)

Mauryan officer Pautavadhyaksha was in charge of weights and measures while Panyadhyaksha was the in charge of the Commerce Department, Sitadhyaksha was the head of the Agriculture Department and Sunadhyaksha was the chief of the slaughterhouse.

122. The official 'Agronomai' during Mauryan age was related with which of the following field?

- (a) Weight and measurement
(b) Administrative management
(c) Construction of roads
(d) Revenue management

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (c)

During the Mauryan times 'Agronomai' used to collect revenues, monitor irrigation facilities, perform legal administration & looked after road construction. UPPSC has accepted (c) as the answer.

123. 'Pankodakasannirodhe' was the Penalty in Mauryan administration, charged for –

- (a) Filthy drinking water
(b) Slushing the road
(c) Throwing garbage
(d) Stenching temples

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

'Pankodakasannirodhe' was the penalty in Mauryan administration imposed for throwing dirt or causing siltation and water logging to collect on the roads.

124. Match List – I with List-II and select the correct option from the code given below the lists.

List – I (Officer)

- A. Talar
B. Pattakola
C. Sahsadhipati
D. Baladhip

List – II (Duty)

1. Guard of Octroi
2. Officer of cases of Dacoity
3. Officer of Night Guards
4. Village Tax Collector

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	4	3
(b)	3	4	2	1
(c)	1	2	3	4
(d)	4	3	1	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Officer	Duty
Talar	Officer of night guards
Pattakola	Village tax collector
Sahsadhipati	Officer of case of dacoity
Baladhip	Guard of octroi

125. The most famous centre of learning during Mauryan period was

- (a) Vaishali (b) Nalanda
(c) Taxila (d) Ujjain

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (c)

At present, Vaishali is a district of Bihar. It was related to both Buddhism and Jainism in ancient times. It was established in 6th century B.C. before the birth of Gautama Buddha (563 BC). Mahavira Swami was born in Kundgram (Vaishali district of Bihar).

Nalanda – Nalanda was an important centre of Buddhist education. Firstly, Buddha temples were established here in the Gupta period.

Taxila – Taxila was a major centre of learning for Hindus and Buddhists who came here from all over the world to get education. It was situated in Punjab Province of Pakistan. It was most famous during the Mauryan period. Ujjain was the conventional capital of Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).

126. According to the 'Arthashastra' of Kautilya the following courts existed in the judicial system of Mauryan Age

1. Dharmamahamatra 2. Dharmasthiya
3. Rajjuka 4. Kantakshodhana

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4
(e) 1 and 4

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

The Arthashastra mentions two types of courts: Dharmasthiya which is analogous to modern civil courts and Kantakshodhana which is analogous to modern criminal courts.

127. With reference to the cultural history of India, the memorizing of Chronicles, dynastic histories, and epic tales was the profession of who of the following?

- (a) Shramana (b) Parivraajaka
(c) Agrahaarika (d) Maagadha

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

The memorizing of Chronicles, dynastic histories, and epic tales was a profession of Maagadha.

128. The system governing villages through autonomous elected panchayats was evolved by –

- (a) Kushans (b) Dravids
(c) Aryans (d) Mauryans

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (b)

The system to govern villages through autonomous elected panchayats was evolved by Dravid (Chola). This system was the base of village administration during that time.

129. Which one of the following texts of ancient India allows divorce to a wife deserted by her husband?

- (a) Kamasutra
(b) Manavadharmashastra
(c) Sukra Nitisara
(d) Arthashastra

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Arthashastra allows the divorce of a wife deserted by her husband. Divorce was prevalent in the Mauryan period. Wife had the right to divorce on the basis of the long abroad stay of her husband and being physically handicapped. Similarly, husband also had the right to leave his wife for being barren or adulteress.

130. Which among of the following prohibits remarriage?

- (a) Jataka (b) Manusmriti
(c) Yagyavalkya (d) Arthashastra

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (b)

It is mentioned in 38th part of Manusmriti that a widower could remarry but a widow had no right to seek remarriage.

131. The social status assigned to the foreigners in Indian society by Manu was of the –

- (a) Kshatriyas (b) Fallen Kshatriyas
(c) Vaishyas (d) Sudras

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (b)

The foreign invader who did not follow priestly customs or traditions (Shakas, Kushanas, Hunas, Pratihar) were stated as 'Fallen Kshatriyas' in Manusmriti.

132. The following persons came to India at one time or another :

1. Fa-Hien 2. I-Tsing
3. Megasthenes 4. Hieun-Tsang

The correct chronological sequence of their visits are :

- (a) 3, 1, 2, 4 (b) 3, 1, 4, 2
(c) 1, 3, 2, 4 (d) 1, 3, 4, 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

Megasthenes came to the court of Chandragupta Maurya, Fa-Hien visited India during Chandra Gupta II "Vikramaditya," Hieun-Tsang visited the court of Harshvardhana while I-Tsing a Chinese traveller came to India in 7th century A.D.

133. Match List-I with List-II select the correct answer by using the codes given below.

List -I	List- II
A.Chandragupta	1. Piyadasi
B.Bindusara	2. Sandrocottus
C.Ashoka	3. Amitraghat
D.Chanakya	4. Vishnugupta

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	4	1
(b)	1	3	2	4
(c)	2	3	1	4
(d)	3	4	2	1

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

Justin and other Greek authors stated Chandragupta Maurya as "Sandrocottus." Greek authors mentioned Bindusara as Amitrachates (Amitraghat) while Ashoka was mentioned as Piyadasi in his inscriptions. Vishnugupta is another name of Chanakya, the prime minister of Chandragupta Maurya.

134. The last Mauryan emperor was?

- (a) Jaloka (b) Avanti Verma
(c) Nandi Vardhana (d) Brihadratha

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Last Mauryan emperor was Brihadratha. Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander/lieutenant Pushyamitra Shunga in 184 B.C. Pushyamitra Shunga established a new dynasty which is known as Shunga Dynasty.

135. Consider the following statements:

1. The last Mauryan ruler, Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander-in-chief, Pushyamitra Shunga.
2. The last Shunga King, Devabhuti, was assassinated by his Brahmana minister Vasudeva Kanva who usurped the throne.
3. The last ruler of the Kanva dynasty was deposed by the Andhras.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) only 2
(c) only 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

Ambitious Pushyamitra Shunga assassinated the last Mauryan king Brihadrath in 184 B.C. and became famous in history for the establishment of Shunga dynasty. The last king of Shunga dynasty, Devabhuti was killed by a conspiracy of his 'Amatya' Vasudeva. According to Vayupurana, the last ruler of the Kanva dynasty, Susharma was deposed by his Andhrian servant Simuk (Sindhuk).

136. In Mauryan period 'Pranayam' was :

- (a) Emergency Tax (b) Love Marriage
(c) Land Grant (d) Land Tax

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

'Pranayam' (Pranay) was an emergency tax during Mauryan period.

137. Who among the following rulers paid attention to the resource management in Girnar region some centuries before the Christian era?

1. Mahapadma Nanda
2. Chandragupta Maurya
3. Ashoka
4. Rudradaman

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

Code :

- (a) 1, 2 (b) 2, 3
(c) 3, 4 (d) 2, 3, 4

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

Few centuries before the Christian era, the Mauryan emperors, Chandragupta Maurya and Ashoka focussed on the water resource management in Girnar region. The Governor of Chandragupta Maurya's Western Province Pushyagupt built Sudarshan Lake and The Governor of Emperor Ashok, Tushasp took out canals from the lake. The Junagadh inscription of Shaka ruler Rudradaman describes the works of both Chandragupta Maurya and Ashoka. 2nd century A.D., the lake was repaired by the Governor of Rudradaman Suvisakh. According to the question, he did this work after the Christian era. Thus he is not included in the answer, so the correct answer for the question is Chandragupta Maurya and Ashoka.

138. Realizing the need for water, the first ruler who got a lake constructed in the Girnar area, was

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya (b) Ashoka
(c) Rudradaman (d) Skanda Gupta

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

139. In which of the following inscription mentioned Chandragupta and Ashoka both?

- (a) Nasik inscription of Gautami putra Shatkarni.
(b) Junagadh inscription of Mahakshatrapa Rudradaman
(c) Girnar inscription of Ashoka
(d) Junagarh inscription of Skandagupta.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.